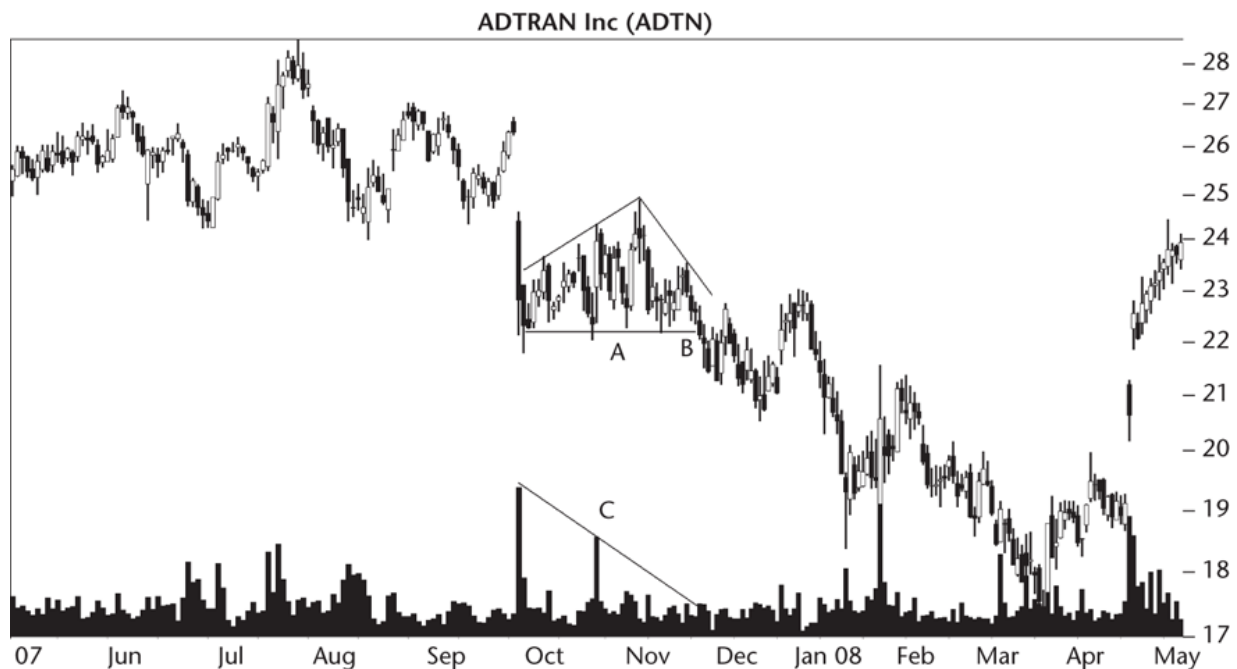


[Figure 53.1](#) shows an example of a roof pattern (A) in a downward price trend. It sports a flat bottom and sides that slope downward from a central peak, making it appear like a roof. Price touches the bottom trendline multiple times and the pattern's sides reach for the sloping trendlines, too.



[Figure 53.1](#) This roof pattern appears in a downward price trend.

A downward breakout happens at B when price closes below the bottom of the pattern.

Notice that volume (C) slopes downward, which is typical for this pattern.

This pattern isn't a complex head-and-shoulders top for several reasons. First, price drops down into the pattern from the top (in this example). A head-and-shoulders top needs price to rise up into the start of the left shoulder.

Second, there are too many potential shoulders on the left side that don't have mirror shoulders on the right. It doesn't *look* like a head-and-shoulders top, simple or complex. The roof can break out upward, but a head-and-shoulders top cannot.

Let's discuss identification for this rare pattern.